

VEGETABLES

A 10-Page Sample Guide to Nutritious Vegetables

This sample PDF introduces ten items with a short description and one interesting fact for each.

Prepared as a sample educational document

1. Carrot

Carrots are root vegetables best known for their orange color, although purple, yellow, red and white varieties also exist. They are crunchy when raw and become sweeter when cooked.

Key fact: The orange color in many carrots comes mainly from beta-carotene.

2. Broccoli

Broccoli is a cruciferous vegetable with green flower heads and thick stems. It can be eaten raw, steamed, roasted or stir-fried and is used in many cuisines.

Key fact: The part commonly called the broccoli head is made of many immature flower buds.

3. Spinach

Spinach is a leafy green vegetable that can be eaten raw or cooked. Its tender leaves are often added to salads, soups, curries and other dishes.

Key fact: Spinach leaves are rich in chlorophyll, which gives them their deep green color.

4. Tomato

Tomatoes are widely used as vegetables in cooking, although botanically they are fruits. They come in many shapes and colors and are eaten fresh, cooked, dried or made into sauces.

Key fact: Tomatoes are botanically berries.

5. Potato

Potatoes are underground storage structures of the potato plant and are an important staple food in many countries. They can be boiled, baked, roasted, mashed or fried.

Key fact: The part we eat is a tuber, which stores energy for the plant.

6. Cauliflower

Cauliflower is a member of the cabbage family with a compact head of immature flower structures. It may be white, green, orange or purple depending on the variety.

Key fact: Cauliflower and broccoli belong to the same plant species.

7. Cucumber

Cucumbers are crisp, water-rich vegetables often eaten raw in salads, sandwiches and pickles. They grow on trailing or climbing vines.

Key fact: Cucumbers are botanically fruits because they develop from a flower and contain seeds.

8. Peas

Green peas are the small seeds found inside pea pods. They are used in soups, rice dishes, curries, salads and many other recipes.

Key fact: Peas are legumes, meaning they belong to the same broad plant family as beans and lentils.

9. Beetroot

Beetroot is a root vegetable known for its deep red-purple color, although golden and striped types also exist. It can be roasted, boiled, pickled or eaten grated.

Key fact: Beet pigments can temporarily give urine or other body fluids a reddish color in some people.

10. Bell Pepper

Bell peppers are crisp fruits commonly treated as vegetables in cooking. They can be green, yellow, orange, red and other colors depending on variety and ripeness.

Key fact: Unlike hot peppers, bell peppers do not produce significant amounts of capsaicin, the compound responsible for chili heat.